Summit. Thereafter, he arrived at Astana in Kazakhstan to finalize the long-pending oil exploration contract which will give India an opportunity to get access to the Caspian oil.

In the sidelines of the BRICS Summit, Dr. Singh met Chinese President Hu Jintao. Both sides agreed to work towards removing the major irritants in the Sino-Indian relation and initiate coordination and consultation on border related matters, along with resumption of senior-level defence exchange, initiation of economic dialogue for redressal of investment and market-related grievances.

In April 2011, Dr. Manmohan Singh visited Asatana, Kazakhstan, to consolidate strategic partnership with Kazakhstan. Both sides signed seven pacts, including a framework agreement in civil nuclear field and a stake-sharing accord in oil sector. The Kazakh President also announced that Kazakhstan would supply India with 2,100 tons of uranium. A great breakthrough was a package of three agreements signed by India and Kazakhstan in the hydrocarbon sector. Under these, ONGC Videsh Limited would acquire 25 per cent stake in Satpayev oil block in Caspian Sea. The two sides also signed a mutual legal assistance treaty and agreed to intensify dialogue in counter-terrorism and drug trafficking. This can be seen as a major boost to India's Central Asian policy and her quest for an alternative source of oil and natural gas supply besides West Asia and the Gulf countries.

As far as Indo-Sri Lankan relations is concerned there was a visit by the Foreign Minister of Sri Lanka in May 2011. Delegation-level talks, between the two External Affairs Ministers, were held on 16 May 2011. Issues relating to regional and international issues of common concern were mainly focussed. The Sri Lankan Foreign Minister also upheld his country's commitment to ensuring expeditious and concrete progress in the ongoing dialogue between the Government of Sri Lanka and representatives of Tamil parties. On 17 August 2011, IRCON and Sri Lankan Railways signed a pact for supply and installation of signaling and telecommunication system for railway network in Northern province of Sri Lanka.

Uzbek President's visit on 17 May 2011 was followed by signing of 34 agreements relating to important strategic issues as well as